

Cache the maps

Google has finally made an announcement that will save you a lot of money. You can now cache portions of Google Maps to view it offline <http://dgit.in/KxCYMj>



Brazos 2.0 unveiled

AMD announced Brazos 2.0, the successor to its Brazos platform, with two dual-core models - E2 1800 @ 1.7GHz and E1 1200 @ 1.2GHz

Lava Xolo X900

Intel enters the mobile phone space



Specifications

Platform: Android 2.3.7;
Processor: Intel Saltwell 1.6GHz single core CPU with Hyper-Threading, and the PowerVR SGX540 GPU (400MHz) 1GB of 32-bit dual channel LPDDR2 memory, Intel Atom Z2460 SoC;
Display: 4.03-inch TFT LCD (1024 x 600 pixels); **Storage:** 16GB internal; **Camera:** 8MP with 1080p HD video

Contact

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Price: ₹23,000

6.0/10

Features 7.0
Performance..... 7.0
Build Quality 6.0
Value for Money 6.5

The Xolo X900 looks and feels very classy. There are still some rough edges, but by and large, it feels well put together. The 4.03-inch display has a very thin bezel on the vertical edges. On the left spine is the micro HDMI port. On the right side is the volume rocker, micro SIM card slot that is essentially a slide out tray and a physical camera key. Clearly, the design is a salute to the iPhone 4 / iPhone 4S, with the front looking something like the Optimus series of smartphones from LG. The phone's battery is not accessible and yet it's not unibody.

Let's get to what you're reading this review for - the Intel Atom Z2460 SoC (codenamed Penwell) that includes a 1.6GHz single core CPU (codenamed Saltwell) with Hyper-Threading, and the PowerVR SGX540 GPU clocked at 400MHz, and 1GB of 32-bit dual channel LPDDR2 memory. The entire platform is codenamed Medfield.

In terms of performance, we were quite impressed with the overall smoothness of the OS, slick opening of apps and no real strain because of the background processes. In a real life usage scenario, the Xolo doesn't feel much inferior to the more powerful HTC One X, and is definitely on par with the likes of the Sony Xperia S! In our benchmark comparison, the HTC One X is obviously the winner. But, the Xolo does go neck and neck with the Sony Xperia S.

Graphics specs, on paper, are impressive. However, we weren't surprised to see the HTC One X finishing way ahead of the Xolo in the benchmark tests, but even the Xperia S nudged it into last place. The supposed advantage on the spec sheet doesn't really translate into actual gaming performance on the Xolo.

The humble 4.03-inch TFT LCD display with Gorilla Glass has a resolution of 1024 x 600 pixels, but what really impressed us was the combination of text crispness and adequate colour punch. Limited colour vividness is very clear when you are watching a video on the device. But, we were impressed by how smoothly it handles fast moving scenes in videos. The only things going against it is its reflective nature, and it doesn't have the brightness punch matching some rivals.

Disappointing bits now. The first being, this comes with Android 2.3.7. We expected ICS out of the box on this one, considering it is a very important phone for Lava as well as Intel. Lava has confirmed that there will be an update for the Xolo in the near future, but we will

believe it when we see it. Second, the built-in speakers are a huge disappointment. They are sufficient if you are soundproofed from the rest of the world, but just do not work for the multimedia bit.

The 8MP camera, at least on the spec sheet, should have been excellent. And it sort of is, for the most part. Images do have a decent amount of depth and considerable crispness when taking shots in good light. Some noise does creep in for low light and indoor shots. Video quality isn't very good, with a distinct lack of crispness and a certain amount of instability.

It is difficult to get through the day on a single charge, with this Xolo under a usage scenario that you usually deploy on your primary phone.

The Lava Xolo has a box price of Rs 25999, and is retailing in the market for around Rs 23000. What we have seen with this Intel powered smartphone is a glimpse of the future. The Z2460 stands up well against the likes of the ARM Cortex A9, but the real kicker will come towards the end of this year when the Z2580 with the dual core SGX544MP2 graphics arrives on smartphones. The Xolo, with the Intel Saltwell processor, is scoring better than the likes of the Samsung Galaxy SII and the HTC Sensation, and is running very close to the newer Sony Xperia S. What Intel needs to solve the battery issue, and get the graphics performance up to competitive level. A very solid start for Intel, but what we are really waiting for is a real "I want this" device.

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